TASK 3: FULL HEAVY VEHICLE AND TRAILER SAFETY INSPECTION

Heavy Vehicle Service and Maintenance Technician Level 3 | Block 2 | v1.1

TIME	EVIDENCE	PROGRAMME POINT
90 minutes (adapt to workplace conditions)	**Practical | Knowledge | Documentation**	**Weeks 11-26 | Months 3-7**

Your task

Complete a systematic safety inspection of a heavy vehicle and, where available, its trailer. Use current DVSA and manufacturer information, classify defects and produce an auditable inspection record.

What you must do

1. Confirm vehicle/trailer identity, inspection scope and maintenance history.
2. Secure the combination and follow the approved inspection sequence.
3. Inspect safety-critical systems and record actual condition and measurements.
4. Classify defects, stop unsafe work and escalate immediate risks.
5. Complete the inspection record and final quality check.

What good evidence looks like

SAFE CONTROL

Apply parking, chocking, isolation and support procedures; do not enter crush zones or release stored energy without control.

CORRECT METHOD

A logical sequence using current manufacturer, DVSA, company and task-specific information.

ACCURATE EVIDENCE

Actual values, test conditions, units, findings and evidence references recorded clearly.

SOUND DECISIONS

A justified serviceability, repair, referral or recovery decision followed by appropriate verification.

You will need

- Heavy vehicle and trailer
- Inspection, lighting and measuring equipment
- DVSA inspection manual and manufacturer data
- PPE, defect report and maintenance record

SOW ALIGNMENT

Block 2 - Inspection, Planned Maintenance and Operator's Licence Compliance

KSB evidence focus: K5, K6, S5; reinforced S7, S8, S10, S11, B1-B3

Task reference: HV_L3_Block_2_Task_3_Full_Heavy_Vehicle_and_Trailer_Safety_Inspection

Apprentice, location and vehicle details

Apprentice name

Date

Employer / training centre

Vehicle / trailer make and model

Registration / fleet number

Odometer / hours

VIN / chassis / trailer number

Job card / task reference

Measurements and technical checks

Vehicle / trailer ID		Odometer / hours	
Tyre tread / pressure		Brake / air finding	
Steering / suspension finding		Coupling / chassis finding	
Defect classification		Rectification / escalation ref	

Special tools, equipment, calibration or technical-information requirements

Task evidence

PPE, precautions and safe-system controls used

Safety-critical findings and immediate action

Work completed, actual findings, diagnosis, recommendations and verification

Knowledge check

1. Why must the inspection follow a consistent sequence?

2. How do DVSA criteria and manufacturer limits work together?

Knowledge check - continued

3. Explain how you would deal with an immediately dangerous defect.

4. Why must trailer condition and compatibility be included?

5. What makes an inspection record compliant and auditable?

Assessor/Workplace Mentor observation

- ☐ Confirms identity, scope and technical information.
- ☐ Inspects systematically and records measurements/findings.
- ☐ Completes final QA and accurate maintenance records.
- ☐ Secures the vehicle/trailer and controls stored energy.
- ☐ Classifies and escalates defects appropriately.

Assessor/Workplace Mentor observation notes

Decision and feedback

Decision - select one

- ☐ PASS
- ☐ REFER

Evidence reference

Feedback and action required

Sign-off

Signatures confirm that this is the apprentice's own work and that the evidence and developmental decision are accurate.

Apprentice name

Assessor/Workplace Mentor name

Apprentice signature

Assessor/Workplace Mentor signature

Date

Heavy Vehicle Level 3

Task answer continuation | Form accessibility revision 12 November 2026

Use this page when an answer will not fit visibly in its original box.
Reference the question and write "See continuation page" in the original answer.
Keep each response within the visible space. Add another copy of this page if needed.

Apprentice name

Block / task / page number

Question / section reference

Continued answer

Question / section reference

Continued answer

Continuation evidence must be reviewed with the original task and referenced at sign-off.